
Cashew


Almond

Figure 10.8: Nuts

Almond

Botanical name : *Prunus dulcis*

Family: Rosaceae

Origin and Area of cultivation

Almond is a tree native to Mediterranean regions of the Middle East. Almond is cultivated in Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh.

Uses

Almonds are often eaten raw or roasted and are available as whole, sliced (flaked), and as flour. Almond oil is made into almond butter or almond milk, which are used in sweet and savoury dishes. Almond helps in promoting HDL (High Density Lipids)

10.1.8 Sugars

We experienced sweetness while eating the stems of sugarcane, roots of sugar beet, fruits of apple and while drinking palmyra sap. This is due to the different proportions of sugars found in it. Sugar is the generic name for sweet tasting soluble carbohydrate, which are used in foods and beverages. Sugars found in sugarcane and palmyra make them ideal for efficient extraction to make commercial sugar.

Sugarcane

Botanical name : *Saccharum officinarum*

Family : Poaceae

Origin and Area of cultivation

The cultivated *Saccharum officinarum* has evolved by repeated back crossing of *S.officinarum* of New Guinea with wild *S.spontaneum* of India to improve the quality. All districts except Kanyakumari and Nilgiris of Tamil Nadu cultivate Sugarcane.

Uses

Sugar cane is the raw material for extracting white sugar. Sugarcane supports large number of industries like sugar mills producing refined sugars, distilleries producing liquor grade ethanol and millions of jaggery manufacturing units. Fresh sugarcane juice is a refreshing drink. Molasses is the raw material for the production of ethyl alcohol.

Stevia /Sweet leaf

Botanical name : *Stevia rebaudiana*

Family: Asteraceae

Stevia is a sweetener and a sugar substitute, extracted from the leaves of *Stevia rebaudiana.* It has no calories and is 200 times sweeter than sugar. The Steveocide is the chemical that is responsible for sweetness in Stevia.

Origin and Area of cultivation

Stevia is a native to Brazil and Paraguay. It is cultivated in the states of Himachal Pradesh, Gujarat and Tamil Nadu.

Uses

This is the most popular natural sweetener and is a substitute for white sugar, hence it is extensively used by diabetic patients and health conscious people.


Sugarcane products


Stevia leaves


Palmyra tree and Palm Jaggery

Figure 10.9: Sugars

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